

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN LITHUANIA

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the land, water, and farms of Lithuania, and one fight over shale gas showed that even a small nation, courted by a global oil giant and told the project was in its national interest, can send the giant away. Around 2012 and 2013, the government invited the American company Chevron to explore for shale gas under western Lithuania — the forested, farmed country of the Žemaitija region near the Baltic — and named it the winner of the tender. But the farmers and landowners who lived on that land did not want their water and their fields fracked. They protested in the capital, drums beating and signs telling Chevron to go home; environmental groups joined them; and the parliament, feeling the pressure, tightened the environmental rules and floated a heavy tax on shale gas. In October 2013, Chevron withdrew, citing the changed regulatory landscape and the public resistance. The tender was cancelled, and the fracking did not come. The details are worth setting down, because they show how such a fight is won — and why it was more complicated than a simple victory. The prospect on offer covered a wide swathe of the western countryside, and the reserves beneath it were reckoned at decades of the nation's gas; to a government that bought all its gas from a single, powerful eastern neighbour, that promise of independence was genuinely tempting. But to the farmers and villagers above the shale, the promise came at the price of their wells and their fields, and they did not believe the gain was worth the risk. Hundreds carried their protest to the capital; rural communities organised; environmental groups pressed the case; and the parliament responded by passing tougher approval procedures and openly weighing a steep tax on shale gas. Facing a landscape of rules and taxes that kept shifting beneath it, and a public that would not welcome it, the company judged the venture no longer worth its while and left — a departure that some hailed as the saving of the countryside and others lamented as a gift to the eastern gas monopoly.

The Lithuania story teaches two things about defending land here — including its honest limits, which this guide states plainly from the outset, for this is a win more tangled than most. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever — the affected community, the documentation, the coalition, the public pressure, and the law — pressed together. The second is distinctly Lithuanian, and it carries a genuine tension the guide will not smooth over. **A determined public and the rural communities on the land can, together with legislative and regulatory pressure, make a country an unwelcome place for a destructive project — even one pitched as the national interest — and send its backers away.** That power — the public and rural resistance, the water-and-farmland case, and the legislative and regulatory pressure that changes the ground under a project — is Lithuania's distinctive lever, and this guide is built around it. What made the anti-fracking fight work as a model, and what a later community can copy, was the combination of a roused countryside with a responsive parliament — a public pressure that did not merely protest but translated into changed law. A company weighs its ventures coldly, by the balance of cost and reward; a campaign that cannot stop a project by objection alone can still make it unrewarding, by raising the taxes, tightening the rules, and adding the friction of a hostile public until the venture no longer pays. That is what happened here: the countryside supplied the will and the pressure, the parliament supplied the shifting ground, and between them they changed the company's own calculation. Rouse the countryside, move the parliament, change the ground under the project: that is the template.

But the same story carries honest warnings, and this guide will not hide them, because the Lithuania win is genuinely complicated. Chevron's withdrawal was driven **partly by regulation, taxes, and its own business calculations**, not by protest alone — the company cited the changing rules more than the crowds. The project was pitched as a way to **reduce Lithuania's total dependence on Russian gas**, so the environmental win sat in real tension with an energy-security argument, and some called the pullout a gift to Russia's gas monopoly — a reminder that a "win" can have complicated implications a community must weigh honestly. And the threat **recurred**: the government later tried to revive shale gas, so the win was a reprieve to be defended, not a permanent ban. This guide is written with all of that in view: the real, distinctive power of public and rural resistance joined to legislative pressure — and the mixed causes, the genuine competing goods, and the recurring threat that qualify it. It is worth being especially candid about the competing good here, because it distinguishes this fight from most. The project its opponents defeated was not simply a corporate raid on the countryside; it was also, genuinely, a bid to loosen the grip of a hostile power that supplied all the nation's gas and had used that supply as leverage before. A community that fought such a project purely by denouncing it, without acknowledging the real concern it addressed, would have ceded the moral high ground and lost the wider public that shared that concern. The anti-fracking movement prevailed in part because it took the energy-security argument seriously and answered it — insisting that the nation's water and farmland could be protected and its independence pursued by

better means — and a campaign facing a similar national-interest pitch must be ready to do the same.

Most communities do not know HOW to make that power effective. They face a project and assume "the government has invited them and the company is too big and it's for the national good and nothing can be done," and never organise, never document, never build the public pressure or push the law. They generate private worry without a public claim. The gap between a community that sends a project away and one that watches it drilled is rarely resources — Lithuania's rural communities had few. It is method: knowing how to build the public and rural resistance, document the harm, push the legislative and regulatory pressure, and weigh the honest tensions clearly.

This guide shows what actually works — inside the Lithuanian system as it is.

The Strategic Framework

Effective campaigns follow the same underlying pattern, whether the goal is to stop fracking, a mine, a harmful development, or another destructive project:

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STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION (find the decision, the tender, and the leverage)
STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION         (build the evidence and weigh the tensions)
STEP 3: LOCAL OPPOSITION       (build the public and rural resistance)
STEP 4: LEGAL CHALLENGES       (the process, the regulation, and the courts)
STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY         (make it public)
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These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. Documentation feeds the public argument and the legislative push at once; the community organises; a protest or a new environmental rule is a headline and a headline builds the coalition. The community that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, is the one that wins — a project stopped, a tender cancelled, a company sent away. The anti-fracking movement did exactly this — it documented the risk, built the public and rural resistance, pushed the parliament to tighten the rules, and changed the ground under the project.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Lithuania's give communities a distinctive set:

- **The public and rural resistance.** A **determined public, and the farmers and landowners on the land**, can make a project unwelcome, as they made Chevron unwelcome. The power of this lever lies in the particular legitimacy of a rural community defending its own water and land. A farmer who fears for the well that waters his family and his fields is not easily dismissed as an ideologue or an obstacle to progress; his stake is concrete, sympathetic, and widely shared, and his resistance carries a moral weight that reaches far beyond his village. When such rural communities combine — organising, protesting, and refusing to welcome a project onto their land — they present a company and a government with a picture that is politically costly to override: ordinary people defending their homes and livelihoods against a distant giant. It was exactly this legitimacy, as much as the numbers, that made the Lithuanian countryside's resistance so effective against Chevron.
- **The water-and-farmland case.** The threat to **drinking water, farmland, and rural livelihoods** is a powerful, unifying argument in a farming country.
- **Legislative and regulatory pressure.** A **parliament that tightens the rules and the taxes** can change the ground under a project, as it did for shale gas. This lever is distinctive because it works on the project's economics rather than only on its politics, and economics is often where a foreign investor is most vulnerable. A parliament responsive to public pressure can pass tougher environmental-approval procedures, raise the taxes on an extractive venture, and tighten the conditions under which it must operate — none of which forbids the project outright, but all of which raise its cost and its risk until a coldly calculating company may decide the venture no longer pays. Lithuania's parliament did precisely this against shale gas, layering new rules and mooted a heavy tax, and the company's stated reasons for leaving pointed squarely at that shifting legislative ground; a campaign that can move the parliament to reshape a project's economics wields a lever that reaches the investor's own ledger.
- **EU environmental law.** As an **EU member**, Lithuania's communities can wield the EU's environmental-assessment and public-participation law.
- **The courts and the process.** Lithuania's **courts and environmental process** are a real lever a community can use.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers deliver clean, simple wins. The Chevron withdrawal was driven **partly by regulation and business**, not protest alone. The project's energy-security pitch created a **genuine competing good** a community must weigh. And the threat **recurred**. This guide takes those complications seriously, names them plainly, and

shows you how to use the real, distinctive tools Lithuania offers — the public and rural resistance, the water-and-farmland case, and the legislative pressure — as the anti-fracking movement used them to send a giant away, while weighing the honest tensions with open eyes.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides your project's fate, at which level, and where along that path the decision — or the leverage — is weakest.

The Levels of Decision

A Lithuanian development or extraction project runs through several tracks at once, and each is a place to intervene.

The government and the ministries. The **government and the relevant ministries** grant the tenders and licences and champion the projects, often as national-interest priorities — and can be moved by public pressure, the parliament, and the vote, as the government's shale-gas plans collapsed under both.

The parliament. Lithuania's **parliament, the Seimas**, makes the laws and the taxes, and can **tighten the rules and the taxes** to change the ground under a project — a distinctive and powerful lever, as it was against shale gas. It is worth dwelling on why the parliament is so distinctively important in this kind of fight. Where a project depends on a government tender and a favourable legal and tax regime, the parliament holds the power to alter that regime — and it is more directly answerable to public feeling than the ministries that grant the tenders. A campaign that cannot persuade a determined government to cancel a project outright may nonetheless persuade the parliament to make the project unattractive, by legislation that raises its costs and tightens its rules; and because members of parliament must face the voters, a roused public and countryside can move them where they cannot move an executive committed to the deal. The parliament is thus both a lever in its own right and the point where public pressure most readily becomes changed law.

The companies. Foreign and domestic companies — an oil giant, a developer — bid for the tenders and carry out the projects, and weigh their own business calculations.

The environmental process and EU law. The **environmental-assessment and permitting process, and the EU framework** are real constraints and levers, open to scrutiny and challenge.

The community and the movement. The **communities, the farmers and landowners, the environmental organisations, and the public** are the force that documents, organises, protests, and pushes the law — the force that sent a giant away.

The Journey of a Project

A typical project moves from a government tender and licence, through **environmental assessment and permitting**, toward exploration or construction — with the **community, the parliament, the courts, and the public** able to resist, legislate, challenge, and mobilise at any point. **Every one of those stages is a door you can put your foot in.** The distinctive Lithuanian doors are the **public and rural resistance**, the **legislative and regulatory pressure**, the **water-and-farmland case**, and the **EU law**. Find out exactly where your project stands, and, crucially, **whether the public and the rural communities can be roused, whether the parliament can be moved to tighten the rules**, and **whether the process was lawful**, because those are often where a project can be stopped.

Follow the Project, the Tender, and the Tensions

Behind a project stand a proponent — a company, the government — and the officials who champion it. Trace who decides, who profits, and — importantly in Lithuania — **whether the public and the rural communities can be roused against it, whether the parliament can tighten the rules and taxes, what the project does to the water, the farmland, and the land**, and — distinctively — **what honest tensions it carries**, such as an energy-security argument, that you must weigh and answer. Two questions unlock most Lithuanian fights of this kind: **Can the public and the rural communities be roused, and the parliament moved?** and **What competing goods does the project claim, and how do you honestly answer them?** The public resistance and the honest reckoning with the tensions are, together, the heart of most such Lithuanian campaigns. The two are joined in a way particular to fights over projects sold as the national interest: the public resistance supplies the pressure, but that pressure holds only if the movement honestly answers the competing good the project claims. A campaign that rouses the countryside but is seen to ignore or scorn a genuine national concern — energy security, independence, jobs — risks being painted as narrow or unpatriotic and losing the wider public; one that answers the concern honestly, while pressing its resistance, keeps the

moral high ground and the broad support. The anti-fracking movement held its public precisely because it did both, and a Lithuanian campaign should treat the honest reckoning not as a concession that weakens its resistance but as the thing that makes the resistance durable.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that can check the deciders, because they are levers too. The **parliament**, which can tighten the rules and taxes; the **courts** and the environmental process; the **EU environmental framework and institutions**; the **environmental organisations**; the **free press**; and the **public and the voters**, whose feeling moved the government and the parliament. In Lithuania, the **public and rural resistance, the legislative and regulatory pressure, and the honest handling of the tensions**, backed by **EU law and the courts**, are the most distinctive and decisive levers. Each is a separate front, and a project that faces a roused public and countryside, a parliament tightening the rules, a lawful process it cannot satisfy, and a case it cannot answer rarely proceeds — as the shale gas did not. You do not have to choose one front: the same case — the harm to water and farmland, the flawed process, the honest answer to the national-interest pitch — can go to the public, to the parliament, to the courts, and to the EU all at once, and each front that opens strengthens the others. A Lithuanian campaign's power comes not from any single lever but from pressing several together — the roused countryside before the public, the case for tighter rules before the parliament, and the honest reckoning that keeps the wider nation on side — so that a company facing a hostile public, a parliament reshaping its economics, and a case it cannot honestly answer finds a venture no longer worth pursuing, as Chevron found.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit months of effort, calibrate honestly. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how Lithuanian and comparable campaigns tend to go, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the **public and rural communities** can be roused, whether the **parliament** can be moved to tighten the rules, whether the **water-and-farmland harm** can be shown, whether the **process was flawed**, and whether you can **honestly answer the competing goods** the project claims. Where the public and the countryside rise and the parliament moves, Lithuania's levers are real, as the shale-gas fight showed; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the win leaned partly on regulation and business, that the project carried a genuine energy-security tension, and that the threat recurred.

Individual Step Success Rates

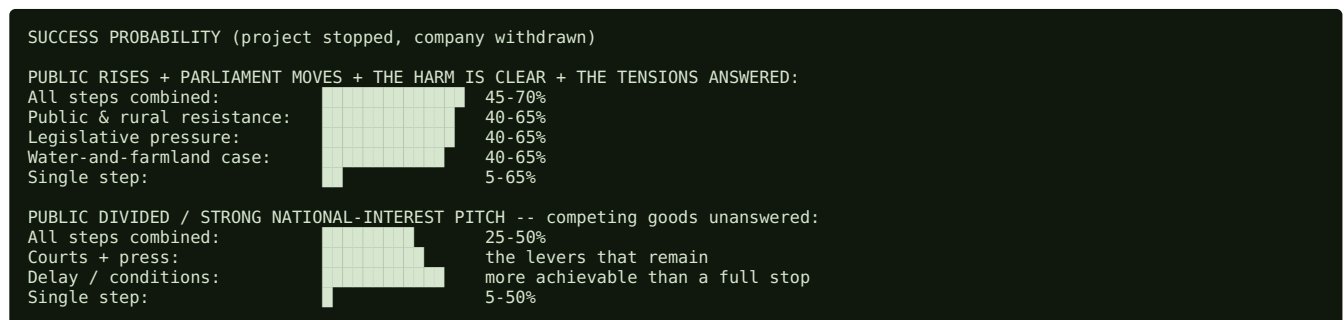
Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	5-10%	months	low	Basis for every other step
Public & rural resistance	40-65%	months-years	low	The project made unwelcome
The water-and-farmland case	40-65%	ongoing	low	The public and countryside roused
Legislative & regulatory pressure	40-65%	months-years	low	The ground changed under the project
Court / process challenge	30-55%	1-3 years	low-moderate	A decision quashed; delay
EU environmental law	30-55%	1-3 years	low-moderate	The law enforced; a permit reopened
Media & public pressure	40-65%	ongoing	low	The nation and the government moved
All steps (public rises, parliament moves)	45-70%	months-years	low-moderate	Stopped; company withdrawn; tender cancelled
All steps (public divided, strong national-interest pitch)	25-50%	months-years	low-moderate	Delay; conditions; the record

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and Lithuania's real strengths are distinctive — the **public and rural resistance**, the **water-and-farmland case**, the **legislative and regulatory pressure**, and **EU law**. Its constraints are specific: the win may lean on **regulation and business** as much as protest; the project may carry a **genuine competing good** you must answer; and the threat may **recur**.

A note on cost: building the public and rural resistance, documenting the harm, and pushing the parliament cost mainly

time and dedication, and Lithuania's environmental organisations and rural communities supply real energy. The expenditure that most changes outcomes is not money; it is the breadth of the public and rural resistance and the pressure it puts on the law and the company — exactly what the anti-fracking movement brought.

Effectiveness Visualization



How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes in Lithuania are **the public and rural resistance, the legislative and regulatory pressure, and the water-and-farmland case**, backed by EU law and the courts. The shale-gas fight shows the ceiling: a roused public and countryside, and a parliament tightening the rules, sent a giant away. But the honest floor is real too: the win leaned partly on regulation and business, the project carried a real energy-security tension, and the threat recurred. Most Lithuanian fights sit between, and the honest lesson is that the public resistance, the legislative pressure, and the harm case are powerful levers — decisive when the public rises, the parliament moves, and the competing goods are answered, weaker when they are not, where the realistic win is delay, conditions, and a record. Read the table, then, as a diagnosis of your own position: a campaign that can rouse a united countryside and public, move the parliament, and honestly answer the project's national-interest pitch is in the strong band and can aim to send the project away, as the anti-fracking movement did; a campaign facing a divided public, swayed by a powerful national-interest argument it cannot answer, is in the weaker band and should aim realistically at delay, conditions, and a record while it works to unite the public and sharpen its honest answer. Knowing which band you are in keeps a campaign both ambitious where it can be and realistic where it must be.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The public and rural resistance** — Lithuania's most distinctive lever; the roused public and the farmers and landowners who made Chevron unwelcome.
2. **The legislative and regulatory pressure** — the parliament that tightened the rules and taxes and changed the ground under the project.
3. **The water-and-farmland case, honestly weighed** — the threat to water and farmland, and the honest answering of the competing goods the project claims.
4. **EU environmental law and the courts** — the assessment, the participation rights, and the legal challenges enforceable up to Europe.
5. **The environmental organisations and the press** — the campaigning and the coverage that give the resistance its reach.

What Lithuanian Campaigns Actually Show

A few patterns recur. **A roused public can send a giant away** — the resistance helped drive Chevron out. **The countryside is powerful** — farmers and landowners defending their water and land are a formidable force. **The parliament can change the ground** — tighter rules and taxes made the project unattractive. **But the win is mixed and complicated** — it leaned on regulation and business, and carried a real energy-security tension. **And the threat recurs** — the government tried again. The through-line: **build the public and rural resistance; document the harm; push the legislative and regulatory pressure; answer the competing goods honestly; and use the courts and EU law** — because in Lithuania a roused public and countryside can make a country an unwelcome place for a destructive project.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective campaign begins by finding the exact decision that governs the project — and the leverage the community holds, which in Lithuania is often the public and rural resistance, the parliament, and the honest tensions. Vague opposition goes nowhere; a fight aimed at "the fracking tender that would threaten our water and farmland, which the

parliament can tighten the rules against" is a campaign — the kind that sent Chevron away. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. Can the public and the rural communities be roused? This is the first Lithuanian question. Can the **public, and the farmers and landowners on the land**, be roused against the project — because their determined resistance is what makes a project unwelcome, as it made Chevron unwelcome. This should be among the first things a campaign assesses, because in Lithuania the readiness of the rural communities and the wider public to resist largely determines the fight's strength. A project that threatens the water and farmland of communities with a strong attachment to their land, and that a broader public can be brought to see as a threat to the nation's resources, offers the makings of the roused resistance that is the country's distinctive lever; a project whose harm is diffuse or whose national-interest pitch the public accepts is harder to fight. Judging honestly at the outset how far the countryside and the public can be roused, and on what, tells a campaign how strong its central lever will be.

2. Can the parliament be moved to tighten the rules? Can the **parliament be pressed to tighten the environmental rules, raise the taxes, or change the conditions** — changing the ground under the project, as it did against shale gas. Give this question real attention, because moving the parliament is the mechanism by which public feeling becomes the changed law that reshapes a project's economics. Assess honestly whether there are members of parliament who can be brought to champion tougher rules and taxes — responsive to their constituents, sympathetic to the countryside, or persuadable by the evidence and the public pressure — and whether the political balance allows such measures to pass. A campaign that can identify and cultivate legislative allies, and marshal the public pressure that emboldens them, holds the distinctive Lithuanian lever; one that cannot must lean harder on the courts, the EU law, and the direct public pressure on the government.

3. What does it do to the water, the farmland, and the land? What **harm** does the project cause — to the drinking water, the farmland, the rural livelihoods, the land — and what does the community stand to lose, as the countryside stood to lose its water and fields? Give particular weight to documenting the threat to water, because in a fight over fracking it is the water risk, above all, that unites the countryside and rouses the wider public. The fear that hydraulic fracturing could contaminate the aquifers and wells on which rural communities depend for their drinking water and their farming is concrete, widely shared, and deeply felt, and it reaches beyond the immediately affected villages to anyone who values the nation's clean water. A campaign that documents the specific risk to specific water sources — the aquifers beneath the prospect, the wells of the affected communities, the farmland they irrigate — rather than speaking vaguely of environmental harm gives its resistance the concrete, unifying core that carried the Lithuanian countryside against the fracking.

4. What competing goods does it claim, and how do you answer them? What **national-interest or economic argument** does the project make — energy security, jobs, independence — and how do you **honestly weigh and answer it**, because a Lithuanian fight of this kind must reckon openly with the competing goods, as the shale-gas fight had to reckon with the energy-independence argument. This question deserves the most careful thought of the five, because it is where a Lithuanian fight of this kind is most often won or lost. A project sold as serving the national interest — energy independence, security, jobs — places a campaign in a trap if it responds only with denial, for it can then be painted as caring nothing for the genuine good the project claims. The escape from the trap is to take the competing good seriously and answer it on its merits: to show, honestly, that the project would not in fact deliver what it promises, or that its promised benefit is outweighed by its costs, or that a better path to the same good exists. A campaign that prepares this honest answer from the outset, rather than being ambushed by the national-interest pitch, holds the ground that the anti-fracking movement held.

5. Who decides, who benefits, and who can be engaged? Which government body and company are behind it, who profits; and which parliament, courts, EU institutions, organisations, press, and public can be engaged. This maps your levers and audiences at once.

A Worked Example

Suppose an extraction project is proposed on farming land, threatening water and fields, pitched as serving the national interest.

Working the five questions: can the **public and rural communities** be roused? Can the **parliament** be moved? What **harm** to the water and farmland? What **competing goods** does it claim, and how do you answer them? And the deciders are the government and the company, with the parliament, the courts, the EU, and the public as the pressure points.

Within a season you have moved from "they will drill" to a target list: build the public and rural resistance; document the harm; push the parliament; answer the competing goods honestly; and use the law. That is a campaign, not a complaint — and it draws directly on how a giant was sent away. Notice what the exercise did: it turned a sense of being overrun by a

giant and a government into a set of concrete, winnable tasks — rouse the countryside, document the harm, push the parliament, answer the competing goods, use the law — each tied to a specific lever that Lithuania genuinely provides. That reframing, from “they will drill and it’s for the national good and nothing can be done” to a plan built on the countryside’s resistance and the parliament’s power, is the difference the five questions make, and two of them, whether the public can be roused and how the competing goods are answered, often decide how strong a hand the community holds.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on. A court, an official, a journalist, a parliament, and the public all move on evidence, not indignation — and in Lithuania, the water-and-farmland harm, the flawed process, and the honest weighing of the tensions are precisely what a campaign turns into pressure, so document them well. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Project, the Tender, and the Process

Get the documents the decision rests on. Obtain the **project plans, the tender, the licence, and the environmental assessment** — and scrutinise them for flaws: was the assessment proper, the water and farmland risk honestly faced, the public consulted, the process lawful? And understand the **tender and its terms** — the ground the company stands on and the ground the parliament can change. The gap between what the process required and what was done is where many Lithuanian cases are grounded, and the terms of the tender are where the legislative pressure bites. Understanding the tender and the legal and tax regime that governs a project is therefore worth a campaign’s early and close attention, because it is there that the most distinctive Lithuanian lever finds its purchase. A project rests on a particular set of conditions — the tax rate it will pay, the approvals it must obtain, the terms of its licence — and each of these is something the parliament can change to the project’s disadvantage. A campaign that maps these terms precisely can identify exactly which changes would most raise the project’s cost and risk, and can direct its legislative pressure at those points, rather than at a diffuse demand to “stop the project”; it was the concrete prospect of tougher approvals and a steep tax, not a general disapproval, that helped move Chevron to leave.

Layer 2: The Harm to the Water, the Farmland, and the Land

Document the reality the paper understates, and put the **water, the farmland, and the land** at the centre. Record the **harm** — the threat to the drinking water, the farmland, the rural livelihoods, the land — that the project would cause, as the countryside documented the threat to its water and fields. Document what would be **lost**. Photograph and date it. Record **testimony** from farmers and residents, and gather the **scientific evidence** on the water, the fracking risk, and the impact. This is the case that unites the countryside and rouses the public.

Layer 3: The Harm, the Flaw, and the Honest Tension

Finally, document the case — and, distinctively in Lithuania, document the **honest tension** too. Is the **harm** to water and farmland real and grave? Was the **process flawed**? And what **competing good** — energy security, independence — does the project claim, and how do you **honestly answer it** (a better path, a truer accounting of the costs and benefits, a rejection of a false choice)? Each is a separate ground — for the public, the parliament, the courts — and together they make a case that is both strong and honest. This is the layer that most often decides Lithuanian fights of this kind, because here a project sold as the national interest is revealed to threaten water and farmland, to rest on a flawed process, and to claim a competing good that can be honestly answered — exactly the reckoning the shale-gas fight required. The strength of assembling all three grounds together — the harm to water and farmland, the flawed process, and the honest answer to the competing good — is that they serve different fronts and reinforce one another: the harm rouses the countryside and the public, the flawed process gives the courts something to act on, and the honest answer to the national-interest pitch keeps the wider nation on side. A campaign that documents only the harm may be outflanked by the national-interest argument; one that answers the tensions but cannot show a concrete threat to water and land may lack the force to rouse a countryside; the campaigns that prevail in Lithuania, as the anti-fracking movement did, build all three and press them together.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

This is the practical companion to Step 2: the specific records that decide Lithuanian cases, and where to obtain them. You will not need every item; you will need the few that establish the harm, the flawed process, and the honest answer to the tensions.

The Project, the Tender, and the Paper Trail

- **The project plans and the tender** — the terms of the project, and the ground the company stands on.
- **The licence and the environmental assessment** — how it was authorised, and whether the assessment was sound.
- **The water and farmland data** — the aquifers, the wells, the farmland, and the risk to them.
- **The economic and energy case** — the numbers behind the national-interest pitch, honestly examined.
- **The company and the beneficiaries** — who profits, and how the project fits the government's plans.

How to Get Them

The plans, tender, licence, and assessment are matters of record, obtainable from the authorities and through Lithuania's and the EU's access-to-information rules; the water and farmland data through the geological and environmental authorities and independent measurement; the economic and energy case through the agencies and independent analysis. Lean on **allies**: Lithuania's environmental organisations, its scientists and hydrologists, its rural communities, and the campaigners of the shale-gas fight. Move promptly: documenting the harm and the tender terms early lets you rouse the public and push the parliament before the project hardens, as the anti-fracking movement moved while the licence was fresh. Timing matters here in a particular way, because both the public pressure and the legislative window are most open early. A project newly announced or newly tendered draws the sharpest public attention and offers the parliament the clearest occasion to act before the venture has sunk costs and gathered momentum; a campaign that moves at once — rousing the countryside, documenting the harm, and pressing for tougher rules while the tender is fresh — strikes when the company is least committed and most easily deterred. The anti-fracking movement acted while Chevron was still weighing its entry, and the friction it created helped tip that calculation; a campaign that delays until the drilling looms faces a company far more invested and far harder to turn away.

The Ground Evidence

- **The harm** — to the drinking water, the farmland, the rural livelihoods, documented.
- **The flawed process** — the gaps in the assessment, the consultation, the compliance.
- **The honest tension** — the competing good the project claims, and your honest answer.
- **The water and farmland data** — the numbers that show the risk.
- **Testimony and science** — from farmers, residents, hydrologists, and the scientists.

Organise It So It Persuades

Keep a **master timeline** of the project, the tender, the assessment, the harm, and every step of the fight — the spine of any case or campaign. Keep a **document index** so any fact can be sourced in seconds. And keep an **argument bank** (developed in a later section) that pairs each fact with what it proves, to whom — the public, the parliament, the court. A well-ordered file is not bureaucracy; it is what lets a farmer, a scientist, a lawyer, a journalist, and a member of parliament all see the same clear picture fast, and it guards against the campaign's own worst enemy, a claim that cannot be sourced when the company or the government pushes back — especially dangerous where a project claims the national interest, and any exaggeration will be used to dismiss the whole case. In Lithuania, the community with the better-documented, more honest file — one that both proves the harm and fairly answers the competing goods — is very often the one that rouses the public and moves the parliament, as the anti-fracking movement did.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION — HOW TO BUILD THE PUBLIC AND RURAL RESISTANCE

Evidence and law do not win on their own. An organised public and countryside do — and in Lithuania, the anti-fracking movement proved that a roused public, and the farmers and landowners on the land, can make a country an unwelcome place for a giant. A campaign's strength here is that resistance: broad, rooted in the countryside, and reaching the whole public.

Phase 1: The Core and the Countryside

Start with a committed core rooted in the **affected rural communities** — the farmers, the landowners, the villages — because in Lithuania their defence of their water and land is the decisive lever, as it was against Chevron. Assign roles — documentation, the water-and-farmland case, the legislative push, media, and coalition liaison. Agree on the goal — the project stopped, the company sent away, the rules tightened — and on what the community will and will not accept. Draw on the countryside's bonds and its attachment to its land and water.

Phase 2: The Broad Coalition

Then widen deliberately. Bring in the **rural communities and the wider countryside**; the **environmental organisations**, which bring the campaigning and the EU-law expertise; the **scientists and hydrologists**, whose evidence on the water and the fracking risk is decisive; sympathetic **lawyers**; the **members of parliament** who can tighten the rules; and the **wider urban public**, whom the threat to the nation's water and land can move. Reach the **free press**, because a giant fracking the countryside is a national story. The anti-fracking movement drew its power from exactly this breadth — a roused countryside, environmentalists, scientists, and a public and parliament that answered — which is precisely the spread a winning Lithuanian campaign needs. The role of sympathetic members of parliament in that coalition deserves particular emphasis, because they are the bridge between the public pressure and the changed law that is Lithuania's distinctive lever. A campaign that cultivates allies in the parliament — supplying them with rigorous evidence of the harm, honest analysis of the competing goods, and the visible backing of a roused public — gives them both the material and the political cover to propose the tougher rules and taxes that reshape a project's economics. The countryside's protests created the pressure, but it was legislators willing to act on that pressure who turned it into the shifting legal ground that helped drive Chevron out; a campaign should court those legislators deliberately and early.

A worked coalition example. Facing a fracking project, the rural communities form the base and defend their land; the environmental organisations bring the campaign and the legal fight; the scientists document the water risk; the sympathetic members of parliament push the rules and taxes; and the press carries it to the nation. No single group could carry it; together they cover the countryside, the science, the law, and the public and parliament — the model the anti-fracking movement built. What is worth drawing from that model is how each element supplied what the others could not: the rural communities brought the legitimacy and the determination of those defending their own water and land; the environmental organisations brought the campaigning reach and the knowledge of the law; the scientists brought the evidence of the water risk that made the fear credible; the sympathetic legislators brought the power to change the rules and taxes; and the press carried it all to the nation. A community beginning such a fight should honestly assess which of these it holds and which it must recruit, because it is the completeness of the coalition — above all the joining of a roused countryside to a responsive parliament — that let a small nation send a giant home.

Phase 3: Sustaining It

Campaigns die of burnout, not defeat — and a Lithuanian fight can run for years, and the threat can return. Meet on a rhythm. Give people concrete tasks. Mark small wins — the assessment obtained, a protest held, a new environmental rule passed, a court filing, a wave of coverage, a company's doubt. Keep the resistance broad and the countryside engaged, and guard against the **discouragement, the division, and the national-interest pressure** — the argument that the project is patriotic and the resistance is against the country's independence — that will be used against you. Meet that pressure honestly, with your own account of the true costs and the better path, because a movement that answers the competing goods squarely, rather than dodging them, keeps its credibility and its public — as the anti-fracking movement kept the public even against the energy-independence argument. It is worth naming plainly the discipline this requires, because the temptation to dodge the hard argument is strong. When a project is defended as a matter of national independence, the easy course is either to deny that independence matters or to avoid the subject and hope it does not stick; both are traps, for the first cedes a genuine good and the second leaves the argument unanswered. The harder and more effective course is to meet the argument head-on — to affirm that the nation's independence genuinely matters, and then to show, honestly and specifically, why this particular project is a poor or false route to it, and what better routes exist. A movement that masters this discipline, as the anti-fracking movement did, turns the opponent's strongest argument from a weapon against it into a question it can answer with credit.

Phase 4: Rousing the Public and Moving the Parliament

Here is Lithuania's distinctive strength, on two levels. First, **rouse the public and the countryside**: build the visible, determined resistance — the protests, the rural mobilisation, the public campaign — that makes a project unwelcome, as the drums and the signs made Chevron unwelcome. Second, **move the parliament**: press the members of parliament to **tighten the environmental rules, raise the taxes, and change the conditions**, so the ground shifts under the project and the company reconsiders, as the parliament's new rules and mooted taxes helped drive Chevron out. Keep it **broad, rooted in the countryside, and honest about the tensions**, because in Lithuania it is the roused public and countryside, joined to a parliament that changes the rules — and a movement honest enough to answer the national-

interest argument — that sends a giant away.

STEP 4: LEGAL CHALLENGES — THE PROCESS, THE REGULATION, AND THE COURTS

Lithuania's environmental process, its parliament's power to regulate and tax, its courts, and the EU framework are a real toolkit — and the distinctive lever is the **legislative and regulatory pressure** that can change the ground under a project, as it changed it for shale gas. You do not need a courtroom victory to win: a rule tightened, a tax raised, an assessment reopened, a delay while you build the pressure, or a company that withdraws because the ground has shifted can each be a real victory. Engage lawyers and allies early — but understand the tools.

Legislative and Regulatory Pressure

The first and most distinctive lever is **legislative and regulatory pressure**. Lithuania's **parliament can tighten the environmental rules, raise the taxes, and change the conditions** on a project, and a project that becomes far less attractive under new rules and taxes may be abandoned by its backers — as Chevron withdrew citing the changed regulatory landscape. Press the parliament and the government to strengthen the rules and the taxes; this is the lever that most directly changes the ground under a project, and it is distinctively powerful here. A campaign should pursue this lever with a clear sense of what it can and cannot do, because its power is real but indirect. Tighter rules and higher taxes rarely forbid a project outright; instead they raise its cost and risk until the company's own calculation turns against it, which means the lever works best against a project whose backers are weighing a return, as a foreign investor always is. It is less potent against a project a determined government is resolved to carry regardless of cost — but even then, the legislative pressure adds friction, buys time, and signals a public and political resistance that a company must factor in. Against Chevron, weighing a speculative venture in a small market, that friction proved decisive; a campaign should gauge how price-sensitive its own project's backers are, and press the lever hardest where they are most so.

The Environmental Process and the Courts

The second lever is the **environmental process and the courts**. A Lithuanian project requires an **environmental assessment and permits**, and a decision made on a **flawed assessment**, without proper participation, or contrary to the law can be challenged in the courts. Scrutinise the process and the assessment, and challenge a flawed decision — and use the time a challenge buys to build the public resistance and push the legislative pressure, because delay keeps a project open to defeat.

EU Environmental Law

The third lever is **EU environmental law**. As an EU member, Lithuania is bound by the EU's **environmental-assessment, nature-protection, and public-participation law**, which gives communities rights to information, consultation, and challenge, and — where a project breaches EU law — grounds to stop it, reaching, through the national courts, to the European Court of Justice. Invoke the EU framework where it applies, adding its weight to the resistance and the legislative pressure.

Where to Turn and With Whom

The legislative and regulatory pressure goes through the **parliament and the government**; process and legal challenges through the **courts**; the EU-law grounds through the **EU framework and the courts**. Get help early: Lithuania's environmental organisations, its lawyers versed in EU environmental law, and its scientists know the process, the regulation, and the courts. Help engaged early — before the project hardens — is worth far more than help sought after, and in Lithuania the strongest strategy marries the **legislative and regulatory pressure and the legal challenge** to the **roused public and countryside**, so that the ground shifts under a project until its backers, weighing their own interest, decide it is not worth the fight — as Chevron decided.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

You have a file of evidence. Now you must turn it into arguments — because the same fact persuades a court, an official, a member of parliament, a journalist, and the public in different ways. And in Lithuania, distinctively, you must also learn to answer the competing goods a project claims, honestly and well.

One Fact, Many Arguments

Take a single documented fact — say, that a fracking project would risk contaminating the drinking water and farmland of a rural region, on a flawed assessment, while being pitched as a step toward energy independence. That one fact becomes:

- **A harm argument:** the project would poison the water and ruin the farmland — the case that rouses the countryside and the public.
- **A legal argument:** the assessment ignored the water risk and the process was flawed — the case before the courts.
- **A legislative argument:** the rules and taxes should be tightened to reflect the true risk — the case before the parliament.
- **An honest-answer argument:** energy independence matters, but this project is not the way to it, and here honestly is why — the case that answers the competing good without dodging it.
- **A public argument:** they would frack our water and land, and call it patriotism — the case that moves the nation.

Same fact, five arguments, five audiences. Go through your strongest facts and, for each, ask what it proves to each audience — and, distinctively, how it answers the competing goods. That table is your campaign's argument bank — and in Lithuania the arguments that most often decide things are the **harm** one, because it rouses the countryside, and the **honest-answer** one, because a project that claims the national interest must be answered honestly to be beaten. Keep the arguments anchored to the same documented facts, so a claim made to a reporter can be backed in the data and a claim made to a judge can be proven by the assessment; honesty across audiences, especially about the tensions, is in Lithuania the very source of a movement's credibility.

Match the Argument to the Audience

The courts want the flawed assessment and the ignored water risk framed against the law, with the documents that prove them.

The parliament responds to the public pressure, the harm, and the case for tighter rules and taxes — and to an honest reckoning with the national-interest argument.

The government responds to the public and legislative pressure, the legal risk, and the political cost.

Journalists need a specific, vivid story with a hook: a rural region's water and farmland, threatened by a giant's fracking, and the honest tension behind the national-interest pitch.

The public needs the argument clear, true, and honest: our water and land, threatened for a project sold as patriotism that would not deliver what it promises.

The scientists respond to the honest technical case on the water, the fracking risk, and the impact.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY — HOW COVERAGE SHIFTS OUTCOMES

Media is not vanity; it is a lever — and in Lithuania, where a giant fracking the countryside is a national story, coverage that carries the harm and honestly handles the tensions is among the most powerful levers of all. Coverage rouses the public, pressures the parliament, and raises the cost. The anti-fracking movement succeeded in part because it made a national story of a foreign giant coming to frack the nation's water and land — while being honest enough about the energy-independence argument to keep its credibility.

Build the Story

Reporters and the public need specifics, and here they need the harm and the honesty. "A project is controversial" is not a story; "a foreign giant would frack a rural region's drinking water and farmland, on a flawed process, in a project sold as energy independence that would not deliver it" is — the kind of story that sent Chevron away. Lead with your strongest verified facts — the water risk, the flawed process — and answer the competing good honestly, and offer a human voice: a farmer, a scientist, a resident. In Lithuania the story of a giant coming to frack the nation's water and land, told with both force and honesty, is one the country responds to.

Reach the Right Outlets

Work outward in rings. **Local and rural voices** first. Then the **national outlets** — because national opinion pressures the government and the parliament. Then the **international and EU ring** — the international press and the environmental networks — because a giant's project and a nation's resistance resonate across borders, and the EU dimension adds weight. Feed each ring what it needs, and let coverage in one pull in the next. The **national ring is decisive** in Lithuania, because national opinion and the parliament move the outcome.

Sustain It, and Keep It True

A single article changes little; a drumbeat changes decisions — and a Lithuanian fight runs for years, with the threat recurring. Plan a sequence — the tender, the water risk, the resistance, the new rules, the withdrawal — so there is always a next hook, and build your own clear record so the story reaches the nation and endures. Keep messaging disciplined, accurate, and — distinctively — honest about the tensions; the company and the government will seize on any exaggeration or any dodge of the national-interest argument, and a credible, harm-centred, honestly-argued campaign is what moves a nation. Verified, specific, water-and-land-centred, and honest — that is the coverage that shifts outcomes here, and that helped send a giant away.

EMAILS & LETTERS

Written communications are how you request, object, create a record, and reach the bodies that can act — the authorities, the parliament, the company, the courts, and the press. Each does double duty: it asks for something and it documents that you asked. Keep copies of everything, and send important items so that receipt is provable. Below are adaptable templates for the situations you will meet most often. Keep them factual, specific, and grounded in the harm, the process, and the honest tensions.

8A. Request for Information

To: the relevant authority **Subject:** Request for information on [project]

Under the access-to-information and environmental-information rules, we, [community/organisation], request the **project plans, the tender, the licence, the environmental assessment, and the water and farmland data** for [project]. This project affects our water, our farmland, and the public interest, and the public has a right to know. Please provide the documents.

8B. Objection During the Process

To: the permitting authority **Subject:** Objection to [project] — threat to water and farmland

We, [community/organisation], object to [project]. The assessment **understated the risk** to our **drinking water and farmland**, the process was **flawed**, and the project would harm our rural communities. We ask that the permit be **refused** or the assessment redone, and we reserve our right to the courts.

8C. Letter to Members of Parliament

To: members of the Seimas **Subject:** Tighten the rules on [project] to protect our water and land

We, [community/organisation], write regarding [project], which threatens our water and farmland. We ask you to **strengthen the environmental rules, raise the taxes, and tighten the conditions** on such projects, so that our land and water are protected. We recognise the [energy-security / economic] argument made for the project, and we set out honestly why this project is not the way to it, and a better path exists.

8D. Court Challenge (with a Lawyer)

To: the court (via counsel) **Subject:** Challenge to the decision on [project]

On behalf of [community/organisation], we challenge the decision on [project] as **unlawful**: the assessment **ignored the risk to water and farmland**, and the process breached national and EU law. We seek its **annulment** and the halting of works, and attach the record demonstrating the flaws.

8E. Instructing a Lawyer / Organisation

To: a public-interest lawyer / environmental organisation **Subject:** [Project] — the harm, the process, and the challenge

We are opposing [project]. We attach the tender, the assessment, and our evidence of harm to water and farmland, and seek advice on **challenging the process, the EU-law grounds**, and **the legislative and regulatory pressure**. Please advise on the strongest routes and the deadlines.

8F. Answering the National-Interest Argument (Public Letter)

To: the public and the authorities **Subject:** On [project] and [energy security / the national interest]

We, [community/organisation], take the [energy-security / economic] argument for [project] seriously, and we answer it honestly. [The true costs, the better path, why this project would not deliver what it promises.] We can defend our water and farmland and still serve the nation's real interest — and this project does not. We ask that the honest reckoning, not the slogan, decide.

8G. Email to a Reporter

To: [journalist] **Subject:** Story tip: [specific finding] — [the water / the land / the project]

I follow your coverage of [beat]. We have a story the nation should know, with a clear hook: [documents] show [finding — e.g. "a foreign giant would frack a rural region's drinking water, on a flawed process, in a project sold as energy independence that would not deliver it"]. It echoes the Chevron fight. I can share the file and connect you with a farmer and a scientist. Could we talk this week?

8H. Public Statement

To: the public and the authorities **Subject:** [Community/organisation] opposes [project]

We, [community/organisation], oppose [project], which would **threaten our drinking water and farmland** for a project sold as the national interest that would not deliver it. As Lithuania sent Chevron away, we will rouse the public and the countryside, push the parliament to tighten the rules, and answer the national-interest argument honestly, until this project is stopped. We will not relent.

Using the Templates Well

Send important communications so that receipt is provable, and log every one in your timeline — the record of a request, an objection, a letter to parliament, or a challenge is itself evidence, and exactly what the parliament, the courts, and the nation will heed. Keep them factual, specific, and grounded in the harm, the process, and the honest tensions; attach your evidence; and route them, where you can, through the community, the organisations, your lawyers, and the press. The reply, or the result, becomes part of your record, and in Lithuania that record feeds the levers that matter most: the public and rural resistance, the legislative and regulatory pressure, and the honest reckoning that sent a giant away.

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME OR FEW RESOURCES: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Not everyone can run a national campaign. With a few hours a week you can still do real work to defend your water and land. In rough order of impact for the effort:

- 1. Document the harm.** Establish the threat to the drinking water and farmland, and get the assessment (Step 2, 8A).
- 2. Rouse the countryside.** Bring the farmers, landowners, and neighbours together in resistance (Step 3).
- 3. Object on the record.** Put your objection, the water risk, and the harm on the record (8B).
- 4. Write to the parliament.** Ask the members of parliament to tighten the rules and taxes (8C).
- 5. Answer the national-interest argument.** Set out honestly why the project would not deliver what it promises (8F).
- 6. Reach the organisations and lawyers.** Connect with environmental groups, scientists, and lawyers (8E).
- 7. Rouse the public.** Take the harm and the honest tension to the press (Step 5, 8G).

Do only the first three and you will have documented the harm, roused the countryside, and put your objection on the record — the foundation of a Lithuanian defence. Then come back and read the rest. Even the shortest version has a spine: document the harm, rouse the countryside, object.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Lithuania's system, as a democracy and an EU member, is by global standards favourable — but it is not without its tilts, and you must understand them so you neither waste effort nor grow complacent.

Where the Tilt Shows

The tilt here is real. **Powerful energy and economic interests**, and a government that champions big projects, carry weight, and — distinctively — a project can be wrapped in the flag of **energy independence and national security**, which is a genuine concern here and a powerful argument that can be used to override resistance. A **wealthy global company** can bring resources and patience. **Institutions can favour a strategic project**. And the **national-interest pitch can divide** a public that fears both the fracking and the dependence on a hostile power. Where these tilts bite, a campaign that dismisses the energy-security argument, or assumes the public will simply oppose a project sold as patriotic, will be disappointed — which is precisely why the distinctive task is to answer the competing goods honestly, not to dodge them.

What Still Works — And Much Is Strong

The decisive point is that even against this tilt, Lithuania's levers are, by any comparison, real and strong.

A roused public and countryside still send projects away. A determined public, and the farmers and landowners on the land, made Chevron unwelcome.

The parliament still changes the ground. Tighter rules and taxes can make a project unattractive enough to be abandoned.

The water-and-farmland case still unites. The threat to the nation's water and land rouses the countryside and the public.

EU law and the courts still constrain. The assessment, the participation rights, and the EU framework are real checks.

An honest answer to the tensions still persuades. A movement that squarely answers the national-interest argument keeps its credibility and its public.

The Honest Frame

So the honest frame for Lithuania is genuinely hopeful, with a caution against dodging the hard tensions: the levers are strong, the public and countryside powerful, the parliament movable, and the law real — but the win may lean partly on regulation and business, the project may claim a genuine competing good you must answer, and the threat may recur. So diagnose your fight honestly: rouse the **public and the countryside**; document the **water-and-farmland harm**; push the **legislative and regulatory pressure**; **answer the competing goods** squarely; and use the **courts and EU law** — while understanding that a project sold as the national interest must be beaten with honesty as much as force, and that a win may need defending again. Do not assume the public will oppose a patriotic-sounding project, or that the giant will simply leave; Chevron left because a roused public and a moving parliament changed the ground, and because the movement answered the national-interest argument well enough to hold the public.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO IS CAPTURED

Lithuania is a functioning democracy and EU member, but no country is immune to the capture of a decision by powerful interests, and Lithuania has had its own concerns about the influence of money and connection over strategic projects, so this section matters. When a project is driven not by the public interest but by the connected, or by a powerful company's or a strategic lobby's weight over the institutions, your strategy includes exposing that.

How to Tell

Look for the signatures of capture. A **project pushed against the evidence and the public interest** behind a national-interest slogan; an **assessment shaded** to favour a chosen project; **close ties** between the company, the lobby, and decision-makers; **the flag of national security** used to silence legitimate concerns; and **benefits to the connected** while the public and the environment bear the harm. Trace the decision and the interests: who pushed the project, who profits, whether the national-interest argument was a genuine good or a cover. In Lithuania, a harmful project pushed through behind a patriotic slogan is worth examining for the influence behind it — while taking care to distinguish a genuine energy-security concern from its cynical use.

Who Can Be Captured — and Who Is Harder

Be clear-eyed about where influence reaches. **Parts of the government and the institutions** can be swayed by powerful economic interests and strategic lobbies. But some forces are far harder to capture, and they are your targets: the **courts**, and through EU law the **European Court of Justice**; the **EU institutions**; the **environmental organisations and scientists**; the **free press**; and the **public and the voters**, whose feeling decides. Distinctively, an honest public reckoning with the national-interest argument is itself a defence against its cynical use; your task is to document the capture, answer the genuine concern honestly, and bring the exposure to the courts, the press, and the nation.

What to Do

Do not assume that a project pushed behind a national-interest slogan cannot be exposed. Instead, **document the capture precisely** — how the project was pushed, who profits, how the slogan was used to override the evidence — and take it to the forces that can act: the **courts and the EU institutions**; the **free press**; the **parliament**; and the **public**, with both the harm and the honest answer to the genuine concern in hand. Pair the exposure with the honest reckoning, so the impropriety and the fair answer arrive together. In Lithuania, exposing how a harmful project was pushed behind a patriotic slogan for the connected, while honestly honouring the real concern the slogan exploited, is often the way to turn the public and the parliament against it — as the honest, roused resistance turned them against the shale gas.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE

The five steps win when they run together. Here is how they fit across the life of a fight — which in Lithuania turns on the public and rural resistance, the legislative pressure, and the honest handling of the tensions.

Early (Months 0-6): The Harm, the Countryside, and the Tensions

Pin down the project and the deciding bodies (Step 1); document the **water-and-farmland harm** and identify the **honest tensions**, and obtain the **assessment and tender** (Step 2). Rouse the **countryside** and build the **coalition** (Step 3). Move at once on what is decisive: **request the information** (8A); **object on the record** (8B); **write to the parliament** (8C); and begin to **answer the national-interest argument** (8F) and **rouse the public** (Step 5). This phase lays the foundation, and in Lithuania the documented harm, the roused countryside, and the honest answer established here are what win.

Middle (Months 3-24): Push, Challenge, and Rouse

Sustain the countryside and the resistance (Step 3). Turn your evidence into arguments for each audience, honestly answering the tensions (Turning Evidence). Push the **legislative and regulatory pressure** and mount any **court challenge** (Step 4). Build the media drumbeat, carrying the harm and the honest reckoning (Step 5). Each front feeds the others. Do the time-critical things first — rousing the public and pushing the rules before the project hardens — because those chances are most powerful early.

Later (Months 6-many): The Withdrawal, and Vigilance

Pursue the decisive outcome — the **project stopped, the company withdrawn, the rules tightened** — and then stay vigilant, because, as the shale-gas fight showed, the threat can recur — a new tender, a new company, the national-interest argument revived. Judge success honestly. Sometimes it is a project stopped and a company sent away. Sometimes it is a reprieve — a tender cancelled, a company withdrawn — that must be defended again when the threat returns. Both are victories worth the fight.

The Shape of a Campaign

MONTHS 0-6 Document the harm + the tensions | Rouse the countryside | Object + write to parliament | Answer the national-interest
MONTHS 3-24 Push the legislative pressure | Court + EU-law challenge | Rouse the public | Media
MONTHS 6-many Project stopped / company withdrawn | Stay vigilant, for the threat can recur

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Lithuania gives communities a genuinely powerful — and distinctive — set of tools, and the honest measure of this guide is how squarely it faces both their strength and their limits, for this is a win more tangled than most.

The strengths are real and distinctive. A **roused public and countryside** — the farmers and landowners on the land — can make a country an unwelcome place for a destructive project and send its backers away, as they sent Chevron away. **Legislative and regulatory pressure** — a parliament tightening the rules and taxes — can change the ground under a project until it is abandoned. The **water-and-farmland case** unites the countryside and the public. And **EU law and the courts** give a community real legal levers. These are the tools that let a small nation send a global giant home.

The limits are just as real, and this guide names them, because the Lithuania win is genuinely complicated. Chevron's withdrawal was driven **partly by regulation, taxes, and its own business calculations**, not by protest alone. The project's **energy-security pitch** created a real competing good, and the environmental win sat in tension with the goal of independence from a hostile power's gas — a tension a community must weigh honestly, not dismiss. And the threat **recurred**. No guide should pretend these away; in Lithuania, the art is to rouse the public and the countryside, push the legislative pressure, answer the competing goods with honesty, and keep watch, because a project sold as the national interest must be beaten with candour as much as resolve, and a win may need defending again.

So the realistic promise is this: **rouse the public and the countryside; document the water-and-farmland harm; push the legislative and regulatory pressure; answer the competing goods honestly; and use the courts and EU law — running all of it together**. Do that, and where the public rises, the parliament moves, and the tensions are honestly answered, you can send a project away, as Lithuania sent Chevron; where they are not, you can still win delay, conditions, and a record. Do it as the anti-fracking movement did — a public and a countryside that defended their water and land, moved their parliament, and answered even the national-interest argument honestly enough to prevail.

A last word on honesty and resolve. Lithuania's lesson is that a roused public and countryside, joined to a parliament that changes the rules, can send even a global giant away — but that a project wrapped in the national interest must be met not only with resistance but with an honest answer to the genuine good it claims, and that the win, once won, may need defending again. The powerful count on your dismissing their national-interest argument so that you lose the public, or on your believing the giant too big and the project too patriotic to fight. Their advantage is the resources of the company, the pull of the flag, and the recurring push. Yours is the roused countryside, the water-and-farmland case, the parliament that can change the ground, the courts and EU law, the honesty that answers the competing goods, and the proven fact that Lithuania sent Chevron home. Play to that. Keep the honest record and the proof of the harm, keep the countryside roused and the answer to the national-interest argument ready, push the parliament and the law, and treat every objection, every protest, every rule tightened, and every giant sent away as a stone in a wall that even a strategic project cannot easily climb.

The tools are here, and Lithuania itself proved them: a public and a countryside that would not have their water and farmland fracked, who protested a global giant, moved their parliament to change the rules, answered even the argument that the project served the nation's independence — and sent the giant home. What decides the outcome, in the end, is the breadth of the public and rural resistance, the pressure on the parliament and the law, the strength of the water-and-farmland case, and the honesty with which the competing goods are answered — and those a determined community can summon. Begin today, begin with the harm and the countryside and the honest reckoning, and build from there. Communities before you have sent a giant away and defended their land — a project stopped, a company withdrawn, water and farmland kept whole. What Lithuania won can be won again. So can yours.